

You should prepare all your documents before you log into the eFile website. See [Preparing Documents \(PDF\)](#).

If you do not have an account, go to iowacourts.state.ia.us/Efile/ and click **Request Account**. For instructions, see [Registering for an eFile Account](#).

Log in

Log into the eFile website at iowacourts.state.ia.us/Efile/.

Specify the case type

1. On the Home screen, click **New Case**.
2. On the Case Type screen, select your case type from the list.
3. On the Case Sub Type screen, select the case sub type. The choices depend upon the Case Type you selected.

Enter the case details

An asterisk * indicates a required field. Enter the case details:

- **Filer Reference No:** Optional.
- **County *:** Select the county in which you are filing.
- **Case Title *:** Specify a title in the appropriate format “plaintiff name vs defendant name.” The clerk’s office will review the title and may edit it if necessary.
- **Prayer Amount:** For Small Claims only. Specify the amount asked for as damages as given in the complaint or petition.

Add case participants

1. Click on your name and select **Plaintiff**.
2. Add as much information as possible.

Note: You must specify either your social security number or date of birth.

For names with special characters or punctuation, follow these rules. *DO NOT use punctuation in names.*

Special Character	Rule	Example	Name in eFile
Hyphen	Remove the hyphen and replace it with a space.	Quijada-Jones	Quijada Jones
Apostrophe	Remove the apostrophe. Do not add a space.	O’Toole	OToole
Space in Name	Remove space.	De Long	DeLong
Titles (Ms., Mr., etc.)	Do not use titles.	Ms. Smith	Ann Smith
Suffix after Name	Add the suffix after the last name.	Martinez Jr.	Martinez Jr

- If you do not want your address made public, select the **Confidential Address** box.

Physical or Last Known Address:

☐ Work ☒ Home

Confidential Address: ☐

Address Line 1:

Address Line 2:

Address Line 3:

- Click **Add Other Parties**. Specify as much information as possible about the other party or parties. You should specify either the social security number or date of birth for each party.
- When finished, click **Next**.

Select the document you want to submit

- Complete the document details.
 - Document Category:** Optional. Select a category to filter the list of available documents.
 - Document Type *:** Select the type of document to add to the case. Begin typing in this field to narrow down the options. If the desired document type does not display, clear the Document Category field.

Case Sub Type : SMALL CLAIM - MONEY JUDGMENT

Document Category:

Document Type *:

Additional Text:

☐ Filed under order to restrict access Date of order to restrict access:

Acceptable File Format Type(s) (*.pdf)

Document Location:

Add to Submission:

Document Name	View Document	Edit Data	Size	Remove
Case Data	form.xml		0.01 MB	
SMALL CLAIMS ORIGINAL NOTICE	Sample_PDF.pdf		0.08 MB	
Total Size:			0.08 MB	

- Additional Text:** Optional. Add a description.
 - Filed under order to restrict access:** If you have an order to restrict access, check the box and specify the date of the order.
- Click **Choose File**, navigate to the document, and select it.
 - Click **Add**.
 - Click the document link in the View Document column to open your document. Verify that the correct document is attached and that it is uploaded correctly.
 - If necessary, repeat the steps to add additional documents.
 - When you have added all the documents, click **Next**.

Review, edit, pay, and submit your filing

1. Review the filing information for accuracy.
2. Complete the Payment Information. If you select Pay at Counter, you must pay within the required five days.
3. Click **Submit the Filing**.

Payment Method:

Payment in behalf of:

☐ Pay by Credit Card
Estimated Fees: \$85.00

☐ No fees for this filing **There are no fees associated with this filing - i.e. Probate Estate Petition**

☐ Multiple Adoptions **Multiple Adoptions being filed at the same time - IA Code Section 602.8105(1)**

☐ Order granting exemption **An order was issued granting exemption from the filing fee.**

☐ Pay at Counter **Non Credit Card Payments. Payment required within 5 business days or your filing will be returned (1 business day for Forcible Entry and Detainer).**

☐ Small Claims FED/MJ **Small Claims Forcible Entry and Detainer and Money Judgment filed together - IA Code Section 648.19(3)**

☐ Government Agency Waiver **To be used only by authorized Government Agencies - IA Code Section 252A.10**

You will receive a confirmation and status updates in your My Filings list. For more information, see instructions for [managing filings, cases, and notifications](#).

4. The clerk reviews the filing.
 - a. When the filing is approved:
 - For a civil case, you can find the signed original notice in the 'My Filings' page of your eFiling account. Service must be arranged by you.
 - For a Forcible Entry and Detainer (FED), the hearing date will be attached to the last page of the signed Original Notice. You can find the signed Original Notice and Appearance/Answer in the 'My Filings' page of your eFiling account for service (which must be arranged by you).

If your filing is returned because of technical errors, you must correct and resubmit it. See instructions for [resubmitting a returned filing](#).

This information is for instructional purposes only and is not intended to and does not constitute legal advice under any circumstance.